



Book Reviews

DEUTSCH, ROBIN A. (Ed.). *Traumatic Ruptures: Abandonment and Betrayal in the Analytic Relationship*. Hove, East Sussex; New York: Routledge, 2014. Pp. 213. Pbk. £25.32 / \$45.95

This book provides us with 12 complex, nuanced accounts of struggles at once highly personal and involving all who work in this field. It is a collection of first-person accounts by psychoanalytically-oriented clinicians who write of their experiences with traumatic ruptures in analytic relationships and the ripples outward of these in analytic institutions; I cannot recall anything like it in its directness. The death of an analyst, the loss of an analyst after the analyst's boundary violation of another patient, the loss of a patient to suicide—the authors speak into the silences that surround these and other traumatic ruptures in analytic relationships. Many of the papers centre on the experience of candidates in training, by authors reflecting back on their early-career experiences. I felt appreciation and—at times—awe for the authors' efforts to engage with and think about these deeply painful experiences.

Traumatic Ruptures is part of the Relational Perspectives Book Series, a series which originated under Stephen A. Mitchell's editorial overseeing and is now under the editorial supervision of Lewis Aron and Adrienne Harris. The authors in this volume are largely from North America. The editor, Robin A. Deutsch, is a member and on the faculty of the San Francisco Center for Psychoanalysis.

The book is divided into four parts, each taking up a different aspect of rupture. Part 1, 'Ruptured Subjectivity, Lost and Found', includes two papers. In the first, Adrienne Harris explores the question 'What kind of analyst am I now?' when her identity as an analyst is ruptured after her husband's sudden death and where 'the central instrument of ... her work is deeply charged with another more private task' (p. 13). The personal tone of the first sentences introduces the tone of much of this book, 'Everyone said, in one way or another, work will be good for you because work will be a distraction. Even at the beginning that did not seem right, in at least two directions. To work to be distracted seemed wrong and a misuse of the work and the patients. It also seemed, frankly, impossible' (p. 13). As in many of the chapters, the personal expands to more general reflection supported by extensive references to the

literature, then comes again into the personal. Detailed clinical vignettes and the paper overall show a moving depth and reach of thought.

Next, Deutsch describes her profound loss when her analyst died during a ten-day break. She quotes Ogden: 'The analyst's death forecloses for the analysand the possibility of fully retrieving his mind (a mind that has not been exclusively his personal possession for some time)'. (Ogden 1997, p. 10, cited p. 32). Deutsch affectingly explores this and in particular how she lost her analysand voice and the hard path to refinding it. Deutsch includes a critical engagement with the literature on bereaved analysands.

Part 2 is entitled 'Rupture: The Clinical Process'. Jenny Randles and Frances Thomson-Salo write (again, movingly) of the resonance of the shame of early loss when an analyst dies. Their focus is on helping the subsequent therapist understand this particular vulnerability in bereaved patients, out of Randles' experience as a subsequent therapist. Madeleine Bachner writes, as well, from her experience as the second analyst (a term she chose after much thought, feeling it describes not just that she comes second chronologically but that she is the patient's second choice). She explores in detail the complexities of working in the shadow of the first analyst.

Jane Tillman and Anne Carter offer an informative paper on the trauma of patient suicide. They examine the literature on suicide and findings from research studies of therapists' reactions to suicide, and the silences that can surround such an experience. The paper ends with Carter's personal account of her experience with three patients who committed suicide.

Part 3 examines the effects of ethical violations in analyses. Elizabeth Wallace writes of something she notes is seldom discussed: the short-term and long-term effects of losing, during her psychoanalytic training, her training analyst due to his expulsion for ethical violations committed against another of his patients. Wallace details the complex consequences that reverberated through all levels of her analytic and professional experiences and manifested only slowly over time. Candace Young also lost her analyst, while she was a candidate, as the result of his boundary violations of another analysand. Young proposes a working model to describe the 'pervasive mode of transmission of the pain and disruption caused by these professional dilemmas' (p. 110)—a model of nuclear fallout, which effects patients, colleagues, and institutes. Like other authors in this volume, she writes of the complicated experience of trying to move into a second analysis. She also explores J.M. Davies' notion of a fractured transference (Davies 2009, cited p. 118): part of what makes a sudden termination so extremely painful is the loss of the illusion of safe timelessness, so necessary to the work of internal restructurings of object relations—the illusion shatters, to the detriment of nascent structures. Furthermore, writes Young, in the case of an unethical analyst there is often a shattering de-idealisation, rather than a gradual one with positive feelings kept intact.

In the third paper, Jane Burka tells us how she was betrayed by her analyst when he breached her confidentiality by talking about her to another of his

patients (a patient against whom he had committed sexual misconduct). Burka filed a lawsuit and her analyst was found liable. She writes of the evolution of her moral attitudes 'from a powerful but restrictive subjectivity to broader, more nuanced and complex perspectives on ethical violations' (p. 126), as, over time, she engaged with ethical violations issues from different perspectives, including as a board member contending with complaints against members.

I was surprised that the book contained no papers by someone who was the direct victim (to use Young's terminology) of ethical violations by an analyst. Whilst such accounts can be found elsewhere, I think it is likely that a reader may, by virtue of the book's title and the back cover's statement that 'Part 3 examines the effects of ethical violations in the short and long term', expect to find such a paper in this collection. I felt concern for that missing voice, and found myself wishing the editor had at least addressed the omission, perhaps in the introduction.

Part 4 examines, in three papers, the impact on analytic organisations of ruptures in analyses. Kathy Sinsheimer describes 'the history of silencing in institutes following reported ethical and sexual boundary violations; the power structures within such an institute and how they affect members' freedom to speak and the ensuing dynamics within the institute'. (p. 147). She describes a personal experience with silencing, where she chose to speak. Donna Fromberg explores the effect on her, as a candidate and early-career analyst, of institutional dynamics in the wake of sexual boundary violations by senior analysts. Charles Levin looks across his experience from candidate to training analyst to illuminate the displacement of organizational dysfunction and long-term institutional trauma onto candidates and early career analysts. Sinsheimer's use of the word 'tsunami' is well-chosen—how do we as communities navigate the seemingly unnavigable intensities and complexities inherent in these ruptures?

The book ends with Dianne Elise's exploration of the question of time, external and internal, as she addresses the loss of the analyst mid-analysis, whether through literal death or the symbolic death brought about by an ethical violation. Deutsch alludes to her reason for ending the volume with this paper: 'for the authors in this book, time has a special meaning: there has not been enough' (p. 7). A traumatic rupture in an analysis or analytic community brings to a halt the possibility of good-enough endings and effective community functioning. Time is then needed for the work of repair, which the writing of these chapters has facilitated for its authors.

One can imagine the care and thought one would put into the preparation for published work as personal and significant as these chapters, as well as into the foreword and introduction, and this is evident throughout the book. The extensive reference lists at the ends of many of the papers reflect this and are excellent resources.

In places, the exploration of process felt fresh and of such depth that this seems in itself a reason to value this book. In the foreword Muriel Dimen says, 'here is analytic subjectivity speaking of itself ... it is given room to breathe, to know itself, a self-care necessary to maintain our responsible, holding clinical presence' (p. xv). I don't think it is going too far to suggest that, as part of that necessary self-care of ourselves and our institutions, we all have a responsibility to engage with this book and the issues addressed therein.

Wendy Maier

The Society of Analytical Psychology

GUERRA, MARIA HELENA MANDACARU. *The Love Drama of C.G. Jung—As Revealed in his Life and in his Red Book*. Toronto: Inner City Books, 2014. Pp. 128. Pbk. \$25/£12

The Red Book reflects Jung's midlife crisis, which—at a personal level—has been associated with his rupture with Freud and a probable psychotic breakdown, and—at a collective level—with the prelude to World War I. However, as Thomas Kirsch (2014) states in his Introduction to *The Red Book: Reflections on C.G. Jung's Liber Novus*, a definitive interpretation of it may never be possible. I believe that the complexity of Jung's process of individuation and his extraordinary, almost mediumistic, powers of intuition make conclusions difficult. With such a rich symbolic content, it is inevitable that *The Red Book* will inspire different interpretations of the inner life of the author, his individuation process and the rediscovery of his soul.

In clinical practice, when we attempt to understand the individuation process as expressed in dreams, fantasies or active imaginations, we link these to significant people, events or contexts in a life story as well as to archetypal patterns that express human nature and psychological development. As *The Red Book* reflects Jung's individuation process, it is natural and enriching to find connections with his personal life, historical context and people who influenced him, be they intellectual references, relatives, close friends or colleagues. Insofar as it reflects Jung's theory of individuation, the content of *The Red Book* is a symbolic representation of his own individuation process. By this I mean that we can read in it Jung's psychological dynamics, conflicts and needs.

Murray Stein (2012) states that '*The Red Book* can be, and is read, from the perspectives of three different contexts: the personal and biographical one, the intellectual and literary one, and the religious and cultural one' (p. 280), and he continues, 'Before looking at the broader contexts, I would like to consider the context of Jung's personal life at the time he began *The Red*

Book and to review what this work meant for his own individuation process. This is an essential context to keep in mind when reading *The Red Book* because it grounds the work in the author's deep existential engagement with himself and his world'. The focus of Guerra's book deepens this perspective, highlighting Jung's relationship to Toni Wolff and his wife Emma.

Some will find Guerra's courageous exploration of Jung's personal love drama highly provocative. Her research included detailed reports by Sonu Shamdasani, Barbara Hannah and Deirdre Bair, as well as Jung's own writings in *Memories, Dreams, Reflections* and other works. As Carlos Byington, Guerra's husband, writes in his introduction, she discovered in this material an Ariadne's thread 'that gives an absolute personal storyline, the light and the shadow, charged with seeking, suffering, guilt and self-realization, that could link the content of *The Red Book* as a whole to an individual myth, to Jung's process of individuation, to existential details that really characterize life as it is'.

Authors including Susan Rowland and Deirdre Bair have described the role played by Toni Wolff in Jung's life. Guerra emphasizes Wolff's role in Jung's search for his lost soul, which she connects with the search for real love. The importance of Wolff and Sabina Spielrein in Jung's search for love is undeniable, and this book is seminal for understanding the role of *Eros* in Jung's individuation process.

The book is divided into five sections in which the author concentrates on Jung's visions, dreams and inner experiences as they appear in *The Red Book*. She interprets these in the light of his relationship with Toni Wolff and his struggle to stay with his family and wife Emma, his search for love and finally his encounter with love.

After a brief introduction to *The Red Book*, in the second section Guerra deepens the study of Jung's marriage and affair with Sabina Spielrein to conclude that 'I therefore consider the essence of *The Red Book* to be the result of Jung's simultaneous relationships with Toni Wolff and Emma Jung, and of the feelings and emotions arising from it. My aim is to bring to light this essence by studying in detail the content of Jung's formidable book' (p. 26). Continuing her analysis of *Liber Primus* and *Liber Secundus*, she maintains that the awakening of the spirit of the depths with Jung's yearning for the soul, as it appears in the figures of anima, is the backbone of *The Red Book* and must be associated with the woman who touched Jung's soul deeply, Toni Wolff. Guerra notes that following his anima was not without crisis and that many of the visions and dreams in *Liber Primus* and *Liber Secundus* refer to this conflict. She shows how Jung got in touch with his feelings, his dilemma, and finally by the end of *Liber Secundus* how he reached a transformation of his experience of love when Salome's blindness is healed. At the end of the section on *Liber Secundus*, Guerra states that, because Jung allowed himself to live his drama deeply, he was able to overcome his desire for pleasure and the power of seduction and to develop his capacity to love.

In a brief conclusion, Guerra recalls an interview with the Chilean writer Miguel Serrano in 1959 in which Jung speaks about the importance of love in the life of a man. She also reminds the reader that 'Jung wrote what he lived and, in this sense, knew what he said. Perhaps for this reason his theory is spreading increasingly throughout the world, each one of us feeling and intuiting the deep truth of the ordeals of someone who experienced them' (p. 103); I think this was Guerra's aim in writing the book.

Guerra describes an affectionate, even passionate, personality, who was acclaimed for his brilliant thinking and intuition but who followed the archetype of the anima and whose individuation process was guided essentially by his feeling function. Is this difficult or even impossible to admit? The future will decide. We cannot deny the fact that love is always a very important healing factor. Jung began *The Red Book* with a wound that needed to be healed: he had lost his soul, he was depressed and empty, and he was looking for a new way. The picture of love and its transformation given in Guerra's book introduces the dimension of human love in the comprehension of Jung's individuation process.

Jung had a very strong internal experience of love during his confrontation with the unconscious, and this is very clearly revealed in *The Love Drama of C.G. Jung*. He had the courage to live his individuation process, confronting tradition with love and even adultery through following his heart. His wife Emma had the courage and alterity to understand this. Barbara Hannah (1997) in *Jung: His Life and Work* says that Emma told him, 'You see, he never took anything from me to give to Toni, but the more he gave her the more he seemed able to give me' (p. 119).

I think that it is possible to delineate other Adriane's threads in *The Red Book* that refer to Jung's personal life or to the more impersonal archetypal domain, and I look forward to reading about them. But, whether or not the reader agrees with the interpretation presented in Guerra's book, what should be acknowledged is the erudition, admiration and affectionate consideration for Jung with which she undertook her research.

References

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JUNKERS, GABRIELE (Ed.). *The Empty Couch: the taboo of ageing and retirement in psychoanalysis*. London: Routledge, 2013. Pp. 170 + xxv. Pbk. \$44.95 / £28.99

The Empty Couch, edited by Gabriele Junkers, shines a light on the uncomfortable topic of ageing and the ending of an analyst's life. Exploring the subject from a number of perspectives, sometimes with a laser focus and sometimes with a broader, more encompassing view, the authors in this collection of essays create a comprehensive picture of the personal and institutional challenges that are being initiated by our ageing population and changing social conditions.

The empty couch, which was chosen to symbolize our analytic work, evokes an immediate personal, emotional response and directs our attention to the possibility of an emptiness in our future lives, a time when the intensity of our analytic practice and the opportunity it provides to immerse ourselves in the mysteries of another person's psyche is no longer available. What substitutes will we find to replace it? Who will we be then and what will we call ourselves?

I'm personally aware that the *Empty Couch* is fast becoming more of a reality among my colleagues and, as an ageing analyst, it creates an uncomfortable nudge that the same situation is in my near future. My reluctance to confront this possibility was revealed in the approach-avoidance dynamic that I experienced in reading the book. At the same time, I noticed a sense of relief that the topic was being addressed, because even though the subject of ageing is gaining momentum in the collective, in my experience there is little discussion of these issues in analytic circles. The paucity of articles pertaining to retirement, possible illness or death of analysts is also striking.

Divided into three parts, the book begins with a Prologue, a conversation between Guiseppe Civitarese and Antonio Ferro about couches, and the rhythm of the empty and full couch that every analyst experiences. Whether it is to burnout, ageing or illness, analysts gradually, through their professional lives, begin to lighten the weight of the couch. As ageing and losses begin to shake up the steadiness of one's personal and professional identity, the actuality of the empty couch begins to emerge, often with some accompanying anxiety. The emotional investment, as well as the time and energy, given to filling the couch makes it difficult to imagine a time when it is truly empty. But there is no escaping this eventual reality, and the growing awareness of nothingness and death requires an active recognition of our own finitude.

The essays in Part 1 focus on an array of topics that deal with the tasks implicit in facing this reality. Several authors emphasize the need for institutions to rethink the role that elderly analysts can and should fulfil in the last period of their lives. For example, the focus of an older person often turns from 'having and producing' to the importance of the values related to 'being' and one of the more important roles an older person may play is in imparting the richness of these values to younger people. Elderly analysts also

have rich psychoanalytic experiences that may be shared with younger colleagues through teaching, supervision and writing.

But it is also vital for ageing analysts to recognize and be aware when a diminishment of capabilities and functions occur. Many of the authors point to the difficulties that can arise and the harm that may be done to patients if this is avoided. Role reversals and care-taking by the patient; re-traumatization and lingering pain caused by the disruption of analysis; an altered capacity for critical self-reflection and containment; impaired understanding and memory on the part of the analyst are a few examples. These potential difficulties raise questions for the ageing analyst regarding his responsibility about undertaking a long-term analysis. When does one say no? Or when is it time for a Society or training institute to step in if an analyst refuses to relinquish his role or does not realize he is no longer able to work? Unfortunately, there is often a collusion of not acknowledging the disturbing symptoms, tolerating the situation and deciding to 'wait it out' in order to protect a colleague, abandoning a situation that is damaging to both the individual and his patients and trainees.

Essays addressing questions of how we apply our analytic capacity to our very own ageing issues, namely our own concrete transience, were particularly thought provoking. Successful ageing requires a growing acceptance of temporal time, a recognition of the historical dimension of one's life and a relinquishment of omnipotent thinking. But there are specific conditions that exist in analytic work that may make this acceptance of temporal time particularly difficult. One is the timeless perspective in which analysis takes place, a world in which linear time is suspended. Analysts may also hold an unconscious idea that their own analysis confers a kind of immunity to the problems that affect others. Believing that their own analysis has also given them the tools to undertake an ongoing self-analysis, some analysts may be surprised to discover that, when the end is in view, old problems, anxieties and defense mechanisms are once again in the forefront.

Becoming an analyst also requires huge investments. Whether the choice to become an analyst stemmed from one's narcissism, a real passion for the emotional and intellectual work, omnipotent needs or idealization of the analytic situation, that investment may leave little room for recognition of one's limitations and failing analytic abilities. And if the analytic identity has served to prop up a fragile personal identity, retirement can indeed be experienced as a painful loss, reviving feelings of exclusion, aloneness, and the need to be liked, loved and admired. But if a person has succeeded in developing a solid sense of personal identity and a 'psychic home', they may be more successful in actively shaping the withdrawal and ending that is demanded by the ageing process. Gabriele Junkers, in her essay entitled 'Later, Perhaps' sums up the challenge and needed response of acknowledging one's own transience in this way, 'To enable us to live with the knowledge of our own finitude, we need defence and acknowledgement in *equal* measure ...

we must continue to plunge into the river of life, while *also* contemplating the end' (p 24).

The focus of essays in Part II of the book are related to illness in the analyst: how it influences the ability to practise analysis; the psychological processes that a severe illness can set in motion; how a foreseeable end is best dealt with; and how abandoned patients may be helped.

Authors reveal opposing attitudes toward questions regarding the analyst's revelation of illness to their patients. Analysts taking the position of informing patients about an illness are especially attuned to unconscious communication between patient and analyst, and believe that many patients, regardless of diagnostic category, perceive subtle changes in the analyst's bodily and emotional states. They believe a factual disclosure to patients can be used in the service of the analytic practice. Others recommend abstention, suggesting that continuing analytic work under such circumstances allows patients the opportunity to unfold their fantasies and eliminates the potential situation of patients feeling that they have to care for the analyst.

Three essays in this part of the book provide illuminating personal accounts of the impact of an analyst's illness on his/her patients. One analyst writes about dealing with a severe illness and her own observations of its impact on her patients. Another essay provides a distressing picture of a training candidate's experience with an analyst whose declining health left lasting regrets and distress that affected her own professional activity. The third essay explores the re-traumatization and suffering that occurred after one person suffered the death of two analysts. These personal stories serve to heighten awareness of how important it is for analysts to thoroughly analyze their fears of illness and death in order to be able to come to terms with them realistically in their relationships with patients.

Chapters in Part III highlight the need for the institution to come to terms with its own 'ageing'. Changing demographic situations, such as the increase of older members, as well as older training candidates, and an increased life expectancy, are forcing a need for ethical, administrative and structural changes. Suggestions about how to meet some of these institutional challenges are offered and debated, such as imposing age limits on future trainees; providing other options in the institutions or societies for ageing analysts to keep up their professional identity without working directly with patients; providing external oversight for retirement; and creating an Assistance Committee to identify and provide assistance to analysts who may be functioning at an impaired level due to illness. Another way that individuals and professional organizations can take responsibility for patient care and confidentiality in the event of an analyst's death is to prepare a Professional Will. A model of such a will is provided.

This book makes an important contribution to the literature on the topic of the ageing and retiring analyst. The provocative questions and thoughtful discussions presented by the authors offer insights about our fears and denial

as well as suggestions about ways to approach our ageing issues with creativity and confidence. The book could be of great value to an individual analyst facing ageing, illness or retirement. It could also serve as a valuable guide for individuals and groups to open up some much needed discussion about these vital issues. My only criticism is that the topics that were addressed were so broad that the book, taken as a whole, was somewhat overwhelming. It could easily be broken into three separate books, which might be much more effective. But it will be a valuable resource for analysts, training candidates and institutions.

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MATHER, MATHEW. *The Alchemical Mercurius. Esoteric Symbol of Jung's Life and Works*. Series: Research in Analytical Psychology and Jungian Studies. New York: Routledge, 2014. Pp. xv +194. Hbk. \$145.

Considering how many times the spirit Mercurius is mentioned in Jung's writings and how large an importance Jung clearly attaches to this figure, not the least in writings after 1928, it is remarkable how little the figure actually appears in secondary literature. Apart from individual chapters from loyal colleagues such as Emma Jung and Marie-Louise von Franz, Mercurius is as good as gone. This is remarkably contrary to figures such as Christ or Hermes, and contrary to the status of a psychological-mythological figure such as Philemon who has entered the Jungian world in recent years. Mather's book therefore opens a forgotten area of Jung's writings, and brings it forth in modern, intellectual-academic research. As such, the book is more than welcome.

One could choose to address the topic of Mercurius in the currently revived research into esoteric traditions in Western history, as rejected knowledge in the history of philosophy, and in the history of ideas and sciences, or as hermetic philosophy. It could also be studied as part of the natural philosophy of alchemy, its theory and practice; or where theosophy, theurgy, and the theory and practice of rituals such as the *kabbala* and *gnosis* are constantly undergoing serious and profound reinterpretations. From a different perspective, one could choose to analyse the Mercurius figure in Jung's writings primarily in relation to Jung's own biography. Mercurius' importance can be seen within Jung's writings as a whole, and not least in Jung's actions accompanied by his socio-political analyses—in essence by his motivation and dedication as a cultural critic. Finally, one could easily focus on Mercurius' role in Jung's life-myth or self-understanding.

Mather has courageously decided to research and discuss all three areas. He manoeuvres and balances amongst the Jung biography, intellectual history, and

the reconstruction of what he calls Jung's life-myth. This last seems to be his main focus, and one he prefers to look at in connection with synchronicity and an astrological context (the Platonic months)—Jung as a modern esoteric. In the first part of the '*Aurea catena*', the golden chain, he reviews contemporary research in hermeticism and alchemy. This is followed by two biographical portraits, one of the English Renaissance phenomenon, John Dee, and a sketch of alchemy as a theme of transformation based on sources from Jung's life and writings.

The second part, Daimonic encounter, focuses on Mercurius as a chthonic spirit and on the *Liber Novus*, with thought-provoking parallels between this work and Jung's later work, 'The Spirit Mercurius' as the core, and concludes with a comparison to Merlin, the wizard of the Grail legends.

The third part, *Magnum Opus*, is a thematic analysis of how 'The Spirit Mercurius' further developed and was used as an interpretative key for Jung's late and demanding writings, *Aion* and *Mysterium Coniunctionis*. Here, the book excels and has an explicit reason to use the astrological Platonic months—the so-called transition from the fish (*Pisces*) to the Aquarian (*Aquarius*) age; a key and motivating factor for Jung's developing analytical psychology as a tool for both critical cultural analysis as well as having a healing potential.

The combination of intellectual history and biographical interpretation is fundamentally difficult. In his consideration of 'The Spirit Mercurius', the author discusses Jung's political-cultural analysis of the conflict between (the heathen) Nazism and Christianity, as an expression of opposites in Jung's own unconscious. It becomes a biographical and psychological interpretation of Jung's social-political analysis of the times. This manoeuvre raises some problems, and it requires a high level of assurance in the interpretation of Jung's political-historical contemporary analyses. I would ask three questions: 1) Was Nazism as a popular movement in 1933–34 (before Hitler's showdown with Ernst Röhm and the rioters in the SA for the benefit of the more monstrous SS), the same as the calculated Nazism after 1942 (planning the genocide of the Jewish people)? 2) Does Jung rather see a problematic internal connection between Luther's and the Catholic Church's explicit anti-Judaism and the Nazis' anti-Semitism? 3) Is Christianity, in Jung's analyses, more of an accomplice? (*Aion*, CW 9ii, para. 159; 'Psychology and National Problems', CW 18, para. 1329)? In that case, one cannot interpret the contradiction of Mercurius-Christ as a personal subtext for what the author calls Jung's 'flirtation with National Socialism' (p. 96). It also cannot explain Jung's interpretation of Mercurius as a process from evil to good, as the author does because of his biographical subtext. An inclusion of, for example, Knickerbockers' interview (*C.G. Jung Speaking*) with Jung's intuitive-rational analysis of the situation at the end of the 1930s would have supplemented the esoteric features of Jung.

The difference between Jung and modern scholars is striking. Jung quotes a wealth of historical texts, providing other interpretations. The many scholarly

researchers the author cites primarily quote one another. The historical texts are largely absent, and Mather unfortunately doesn't seem to know of such authors as Alfred Ribb and Theodor Abt, who engage the texts themselves, and those issues and opportunities they bring about in our modern world.

In my eyes, the book is strongest in its motif analysis of Jung's late writings. There is a wealth of hints, possible contexts, and new stimulating insights from the author himself. Mather is extremely clear and precise in his exposition and is a joy to read. It is by the questions raised that this work may have its highest value. Mather has made a major contribution to an otherwise neglected subject, and the book provides stimulation for both the therapeutic and the academic Jung reader.

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EKSTROM, S.R. *Memory and Healing. Neurocognitive and Psychodynamic Perspectives on how Patients and Psychotherapists Remember*. London: Karnac. 2014. Pp. 304. Pbk. £22.99.

This is undoubtedly one of the most important Jungian contributions to the growing literature which seeks to explore the many ways in which insights from neuroscience can enrich our understanding of clinical practice. Throughout the book, the importance of the memory in the analytic process is emphasized and explicated; not only the memories of the patient but also the vital contribution of the memory of the therapist. Ekstrom tends to use the terms 'psychotherapy' and 'psychoanalysis' interchangeably. He conducts an exhaustive review of research into memory processes and its relevance for the consulting room. His approach is grounded in cognitive neuroscience rather than the neurobiology of emotion or attachment.

Ekstrom, in the first section of his book, called 'Applying the findings in research', begins by exploring why research on memory is critical to the practice of psychotherapy. He moves on to discuss the nature of subjectivity and the significance of episodic memory for an understanding of this. He then turns to autobiographical memory and the value of adequate understanding of it for the construction of the individual's history and sense of self. The first part of the book is completed by an exploration of three aspects of the clinical endeavour: the development of narrative, dreams as a form of narrative, and metaphors and the meaning-making process. While readers will be aware that much of this section of the book has been explored before by other writers, nevertheless Ekstrom reviews the research literature on memory in a way that clarifies its relevance to clinical practice.

It is in the second section of the book, entitled 'Remembering, reporting and teaching', that Ekstrom really breaks new ground. Here his focus is on the

memory of therapists rather than patients, and the ways in which therapists may develop their abilities to use their own memory effectively in the therapeutic encounter and the reporting of it. He emphasizes the reciprocal and dyadic aspects of therapy and the importance of the therapist's memory for both partners engaged in the process. In the first chapter of this section, entitled 'where it happens and how', the author 'calls for major changes in how psychotherapists present their work' (p. xvi). It offers an interesting exposition of the complex listening, absorbing and encoding of the verbal, and much more than merely the verbal, that occurs in the consulting room and current understanding of short term working memory and executive function. There is a helpful discussion of the nature and limitations of case reports in a sub-section rather pessimistically entitled 'an encounter barely remembered' (p. 178). I felt the reader would have benefitted from some final reflections from the author, who seems to gallop through the research without offering an overview of the major changes that were promised. The subsequent chapter 'What there is to tell' seems to redress the balance.

This chapter (8) offers a very practical discussion of the tensions that may exist, for instance between treatment and research, and between the actual therapeutic encounter and the reporting of it for different audiences and different purposes. The author then discusses the six dimensions of a treatment that merit the reporter's attention (patient's explicit communication, and that of the therapist; nonverbal communication of the patient, and the therapist; the internal processes of the patient, and of the therapist). Ekstrom concludes the chapter with a warning that, in his view, 'what can be reported about a particular psychotherapy will not meet the standards used for conducting research' (p. 211). For this statement to be justified effectively, I think the author would need to expand his argument in a way that reaches beyond the scope of this book or the declared aim of the author in writing it.

The final chapter of the book, entitled 'Listening in a different state of mind', returns psychotherapy to its roots by revisiting Freud's own formulation about his use of memory as a therapist. The chapter provides a very useful teaching tool, offering an overview of what psychotherapy is about. Ekstrom provides a thoughtful summary of what training as an analyst entails. He explores listening and conscious memory and the relational aspects of listening. He then offers a historical perspective on the nature of psychotherapy, revisiting Freud and Jung's technique and the development of training of psychotherapists. He identifies three main training tools: learning from being a patient; learning from another therapist in supervision; and, thirdly, the skill of assessing and planning treatments. I felt that this summary, although extremely valuable as a teaching tool itself, lacked any emphasis on the value of shared seminar experiences for a group of trainees. I think this is a pity, as this book is ideally suited to be included on the reading list for such seminars for trainees.

Ekstrom also suggests that a fourth essential training tool is often underemphasized and the conclusion to his book stresses that '*the ability to*

retain first-hand memory about each patient must be the main goal in training therapists and must be the criterion for the feasibility of training' (pp. 234–35, [italics are the author's]). Here he does return briefly to the theme of the book, 'Memory and Healing'; I would have appreciated a concluding chapter that revisited this in more depth.

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